

Properties of inequality



1 18 is not greater than 23 or 18 is less than or equal to 23

2

a

i $13 < 16$

ii Yes

b

i $16 > 13$

ii Yes

c

i $-8 < -5$

ii Yes

d

i $7 > 1$

ii Yes

e

i $-4 < -2$

ii Yes

f

i $9 > 7$

ii Yes

g

i $10 < 14$

ii Yes

h

i $-24 < -40$

ii No

i

i $\frac{5}{6} > \frac{2}{6}$

ii Yes

j

i $-\frac{8}{4} < -\frac{12}{4}$

ii No

3 For $a < b$ to be true, a must lie to the left of b on a number line.

Since adding 1 to a number is equivalent to moving that number to the right on a number line, the distance between them on the line will remain the same, so $a + 1$ will still be to the left of $b + 1$.

This same logic applies for $a - 1 < b - 1$, and extends to the general case of $a + n < b + n$ as well.

4

a False

b False

c True

d True

5

a True

b True

c False

d True

6

a Yes

b No

c Yes

d Yes

7

a Yes

b Yes

c No

d Yes

8

a False

b True

c True

d False



$$a + a < b + a$$

$$a + a + a < b + a + a$$

$$3a < b + a + a$$

$$3a < b + b + b$$

$$3a < 3b$$